Data Analysis through Affinity Map

Social Influence on Gaming Behavior

"you can't play games by yourself. You must play with someone you're familiar with"
— Interview 1

"the most important part for me is friends... I only want to get, like, a sense of entertainment, uh, when I play games."
— Interview 2

“sometimes it's just, my friend, she want to play with me, so I feel, oh, it's okay. Let's play together and chatting during the game."
— Interview 3

"If everyone is still online... leaving the game feels a bit awkward. I'm feeling lonely as well."
— Interview 4

"play with friends always made the time... more or lasted than expected."
— Interview 5

"if you play with your friend... they are chatting on discord where you are playing... it will be so much fun."
— Interview 6

"The reason I like it is because many of my friends around me are playing it... when I'm bored, being able to play with friends makes me very happy."
— Interview 7

"my friend said that we want to get the first blood and so I think I continue to play that until... we beat the boss."
— Interview 8

"if some of my friends... played the same game or have the wish to play the same game with me... I were very happy."
— Interview 9

"it's harder to stop when my friend, when my friends play, play with me, yeah."
— Interview 10

Self-Perception and Family Regulation

"the relationship between you and your family... can get worse"
— Interview 1

"my parents told me you could only play games on... Friday nights" ... "they don't even know I got my own... PC"
— Interview 2

"I will use eye drops when I play games and my eyes feel too tired."
— Interview 3

"I will give me a set attempt... one hour, 2 hour... extract myself from... reality to go back to do the I have."
— Interview 4

"they only controlled me when I was a kid... when I grow up, they were not... say many things about this."
— Interview 5

"none of them worked... I just found another so much fun."
— Interview 6

"if I'm going to bed at 10 o'clock, then after 7 o'clock I won't accept friends' invitations to play games with them anymore."
— Interview 7

"I set up a... timer. So I want to see... how long I play... I think that's worked."
— Interview 8

"I just went back defended my interests with my effort... my grade... it just persuaded them that the gaming will not affect my daily life."
— Interview 9

"Back around the lunch time, I felt extremely tired and uncomfortable... even after I stop... I still felt... tired."
— Interview 10

The "Unfinished" Compulsion

"we just keep playing, keep playing, keep failing, keep failing"
— Interview 1

"every time I started, I know I'm gonna, like, quit it, like, end up, like, playing for a long time."
— Interview 2

"after losing, I want to win. I want to be a game before I stop... then suddenly another 2 hours have passed."
— Interview 4

"I almost reached the the level of diamond... the score is enough for me to, to, to the next level... I' would really keep playing that."
— Interview 5

"if you achieve the hundred levels will give you... a very brilliant... skin of a god, so I just want this game."
— Interview 6

"my friends kept saying to play with them a bit longer, or... log off after finishing just this one match, so... I accompanied them and played for a long time."
— Interview 7

"the gaming story is not ending, so I want to see what's the end... I continue playing for a very long time... longer than my expectation."
— Interview 8

"I just want to... have some fun and release my stress so I just keep playing and I don't want to stop... until I am fulfilled."
— Interview 9

"even though I've already lost several games... I still thinking maybe I will win the next one so I just keep playing."
— Interview 10

Insight

Games with strong social features, like team-based matches or voice chat with friends, are harder to put down than games played alone. Players rarely decide to stop on their own. If friends are still online, it's hard to leave first, and a friend asking you to stay longer is often enough to keep someone playing who already wanted to stop.

Design Opportunity

Since stopping is really a group decision, not an individual one, the opportunity isn't building tools that try to boost individual self-control, since those have mostly failed. It's about turning stopping from something one person has to fight social pressure to do, into something the group agrees on together.